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General Comment

As both an educator and a creative writer, I urge the AI action plan of the United States needs to restrain the abusive and rights-violating practices of AI developers and institute guard-rails to prevent AI tools from depriving the next generation of the opportunity to learn skills and develop their intellect.

That last point is important, so I will start there. As a teacher, I have seen how destructive large language models are to the education system. It has always been the case that many students would rather not do the work required to learn. Now, there is a perfect tool for them to avoid work, one that can generate the kinds of simple essays or complete the kinds of simple math problems or lab reports that students are assigned (and even include some of the simple mistakes that students tend to make - more on that later!). American education is already struggling. Generative AI has only made that struggle worse, as students turn to and educators are forced to take time away from actually teaching, giving feedback, or developing lessons to identify and document this AI-plagiarism.

Some large language models and AI tools have their uses, particularly in the sciences and medical fields. Generative AI, however, is largely a scam. This technology is impressive to the ignorant, but embarrassing to the informed. It makes frequent mistakes, provides factually inaccurate responses to prompts, and will invent sources of information whole-sale. Notoriously, lawyers have been reprimanded and sanctioned by the courts for utilizing AI that fabricated case law that did not actually exist. Researchers have been caught submitting bibliographies that include citations to papers which were never published. These tools present themselves as reliable, but they do not process information or knowledge. They simply produce strings of text or tokens based on a complex statistical process, guessing what should come next to satisfy the person who queried them. Referring to these tools as "intelligent" is largely a marketing ploy. They are not meaningfully so, and some researchers have openly stated skepticism about their ability to ever become so. Why should we then obliterate our copyright system, which protects the ability of working creatives to make a living, in order to facilitate the further development of these massively expensive, resource-devouring machines that do not even do the thing they claim to do?

Sam Altman has publicly admitted that AI development is impossible without stealing from creatives. That the need of these models for training data is so enormous and insatiable that the copyright system must be done away with to feed them. To that I say, if you cannot operate your business in a way that is fair and legal, you do not have the right to operate your business. And the fact that Altman's businesses are massively unprofitable and require constant injections of venture capital, even as his company has blatantly stolen data and creative work to feed their machines, reveals that even WHILE breaking the law he cannot create something worthwhile.

At the end of the day, these AI-boosters believe that this product is worth developing for the simple reason that it will one day replace workers. That they will no longer need to pay skilled American trades and craftspeople to develop software, write prose, create art, or, eventually, do any other work at all. They dream of a world without us, where our work has been used to feed a general artificial intelligence which they can then use to replace us. And to build it, they want to steal from us. They want to take our work, and then enslave us by proxy through the machine they will build with our work. It is a travesty of justice and a betrayal of the American people to allow this to happen.